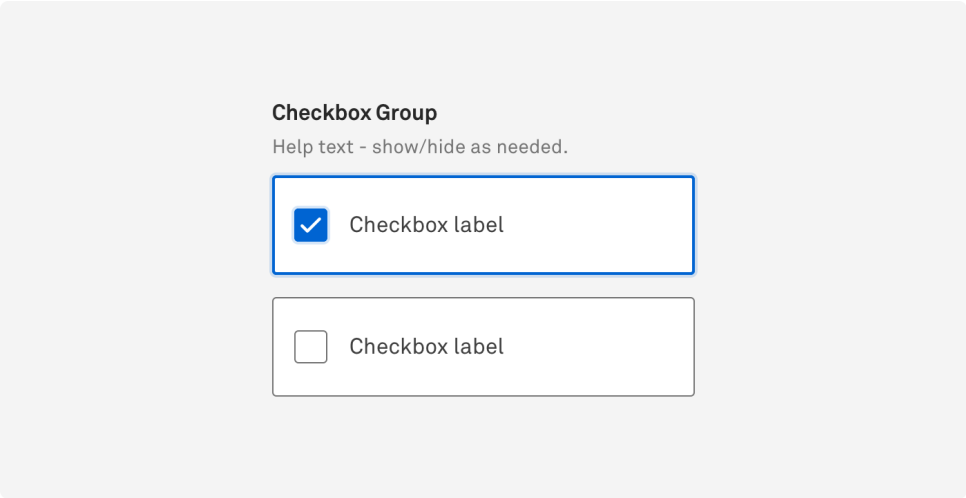
*Need help? Self-Service || Yammer || **No new spaces from Nov-23rd***

Checkbox Group

Created by Tony Wang, last modified by Genevieve Wang on 03 Mar 2021



Version

2

Availability

Web

On This Page

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A checkbox group allows users to select zero, one, or many options from a set.

Useful Docs

- Writing Checkbox Labels
- When to Use Compact or Comfortable
- Using Images to Support Text Labels
- Checkbox & Radio UI Improvement
- Interaction for Selection Controls
- Don't use Checkbox for T&Cs

Specs

- Checkbox (Web)
- Form Labels (Web)

UI Playground

- Web Playground
- React Playground

Usage Guidelines

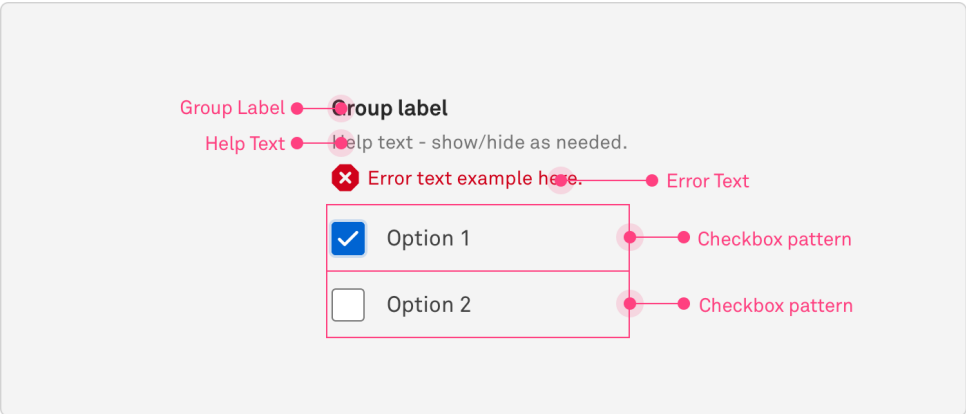
When to use a Checkbox Group:

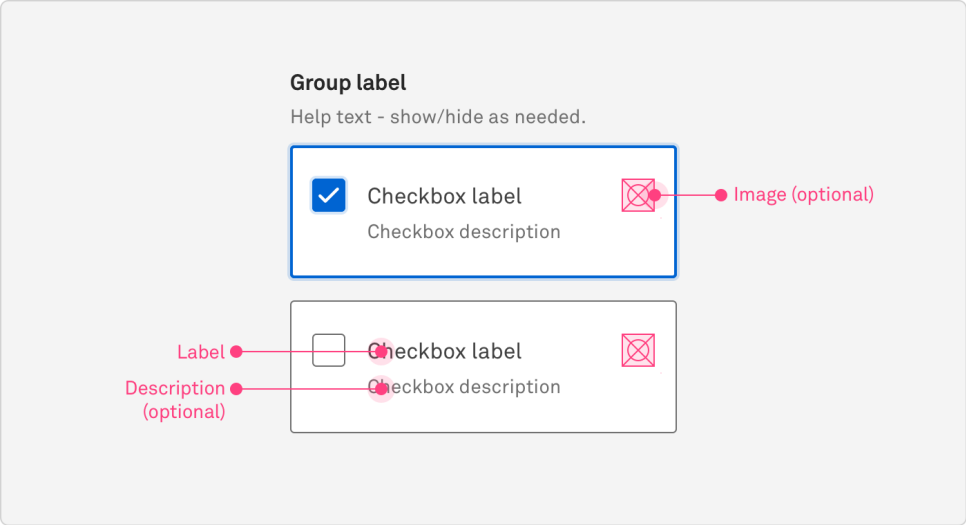
- Display 1 or more checkbox options that are related in its group.
- Allow users to select any number (0–all) of options from a set.
- Allow users to make a minimum selection from a list of options.
- Allow users to make a maximum selection (2+) from a list of options.

Don't use Checkbox Group if:

- User must select exactly 1 option from the list. Use Radio Group instead.
- The list of options are mutually exclusive (e.g. Yes / No). Use Radio Group instead.
- The resulting action is applied immediately. Use Switch Row instead.

Anatomy



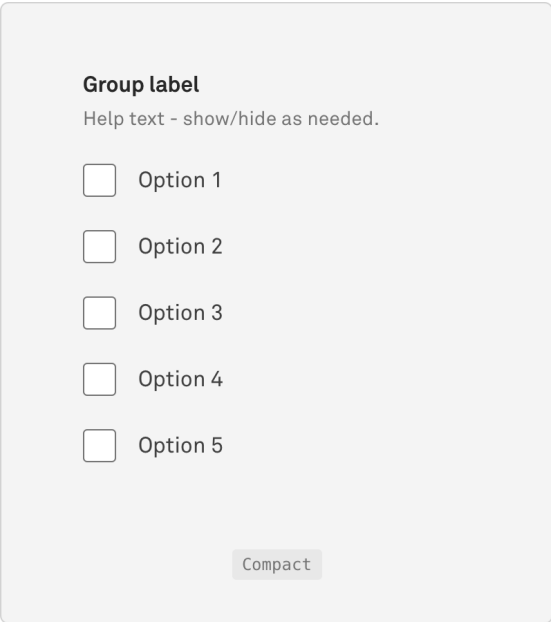


Variants

There are 2 variants to choose from — *Compact Group* and *Comfortable Group*.

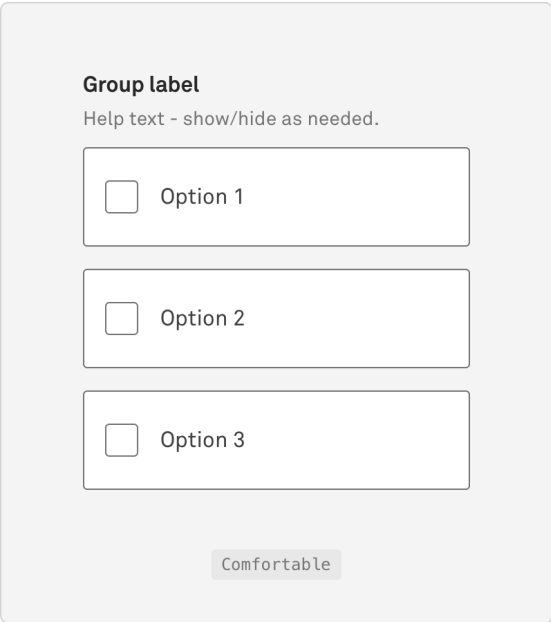
For guidance on the which variant to use, see When to Use Compact or Comfortable.

Compact Group



Designed to help user scan through ALL the available options and **make a simple decision quickly**.

Comfortable Group

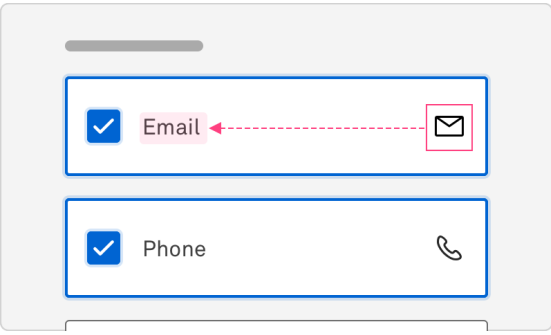


Designed to guide user to **make an important (or a complex) decision** by putting more emphasis on the option user is selecting.

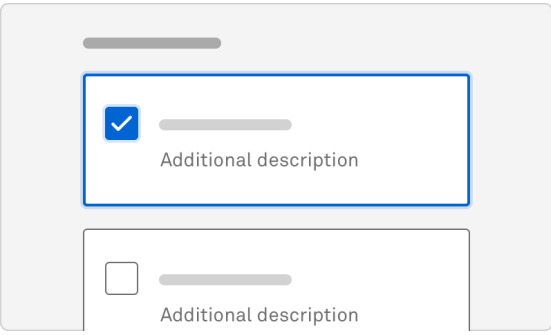
Supporting Your Selection Options

In the Comfortable Group variant, you have the ability to:

Add a Supporting Image



Add an Additional Description



Adding a supporting Image can **help convey the radio option quickly to our users**.

To learn more about choosing a supporting image, see Using Images to Support Text Labels.

Image types that can be used in Checkbox Group:

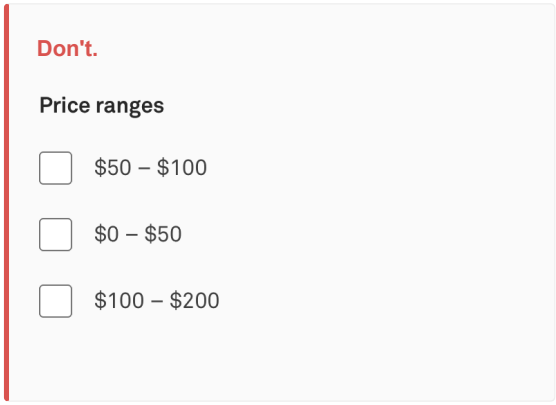
- Icon in 24x24
- Pictogram in 56x56

Additional description provides **more clarification on the options** you're providing.

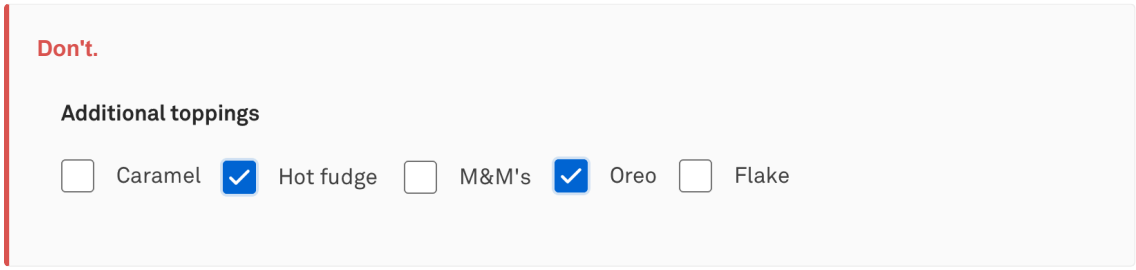
For more guidance on additional description, see Checkbox Description in Content Guidelines.

Best Practices

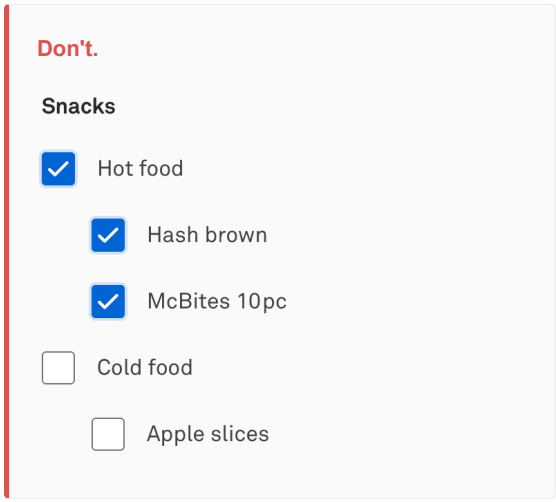
- **Selecting a checkbox does not apply the action immediately.**
  When user selects or deselects a checkbox, it should not take effect until the user performs a save/submit action. Exception is for filtering checkboxes, which can be applied instantly.
- **Checkboxes work independently from each other.**
  Selecting one checkbox shouldn't change the selection status of another checkbox in the list. Exception is when a checkbox is used to make a bulk selection of multiple items.
- **List options in a logical order.**
  Be listed according to a logical order, which can be alphabetical, numerical, popularity-based, or any other clear system.

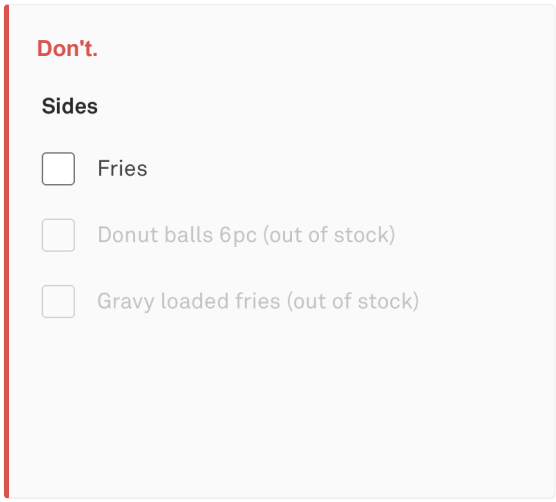


- **Always options stack vertically.**
  This helps users identify which label corresponds with which checkbox indicator, and distinguish checkbox states easily in a list format.

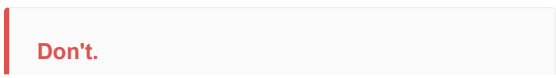


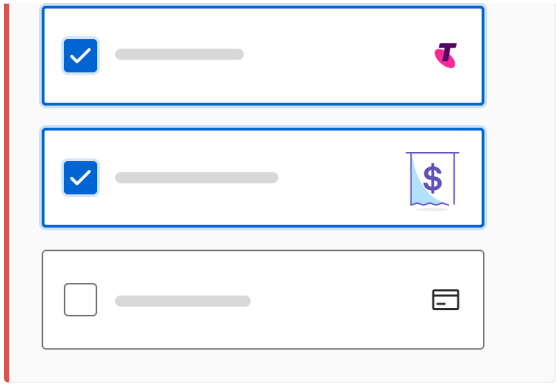
- **Nested checkboxes and disabled checkboxes are not supported.**





- **Don't combine different image types in the same Checkbox Group.**
  The supporting images should be the same type within the same group.

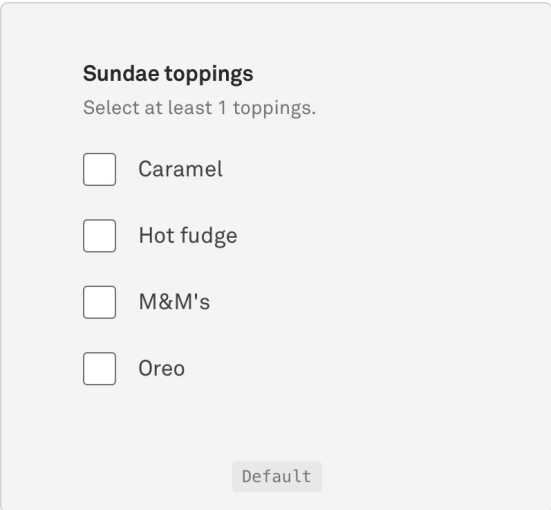




States

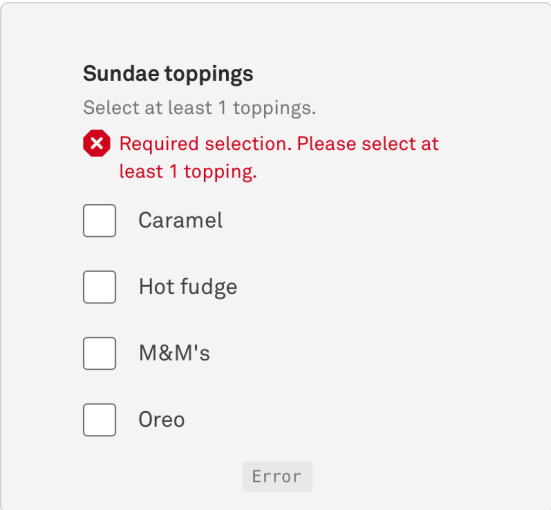
Each Checkbox Group has a Default state and an Error state.

Default State



Users can make their selection freely in the Default state without any interruption.

Error State



Error state will only appear when a group has a specific requirement (e.g. minimum selection).

The validation should be triggered when user submits the form. It's recommended to have an error persist while user interacts with the checkbox.

When the user has fixed their selection, the error should disappear when:

- Focus moves out of the group, or
- User submits the form again.

Content Guidelines

This section provides guidance on how to write effective copy for each text element inside a checkbox group. For standard guidelines on writing effective copy, please refer to Telstra's Content Style Guide.

1. Group Label
2. Help Text
3. Error Text
4. Checkbox Label
5. Checkbox Description

1. Group Label

A checkbox group always contains a group label which helps users understand the relationship of the checkbox options. Don't assume the checkbox options are self-explanatory without a group label.

Group label should:

- Describe the grouping category for context and clarity.
- Ideally label nouns in plural form. Exception is for product filters which should be written in singular form.
- Be phrased consistently with text field labels within a form or page (as single phrase or question).
- Be succinct and short (1–3 words), avoiding long sentence labels.
- Use sentence case with no punctuation.

Do.

Marketing preferences

Don't.

Select your Marketing Preferences:

2. Help Text

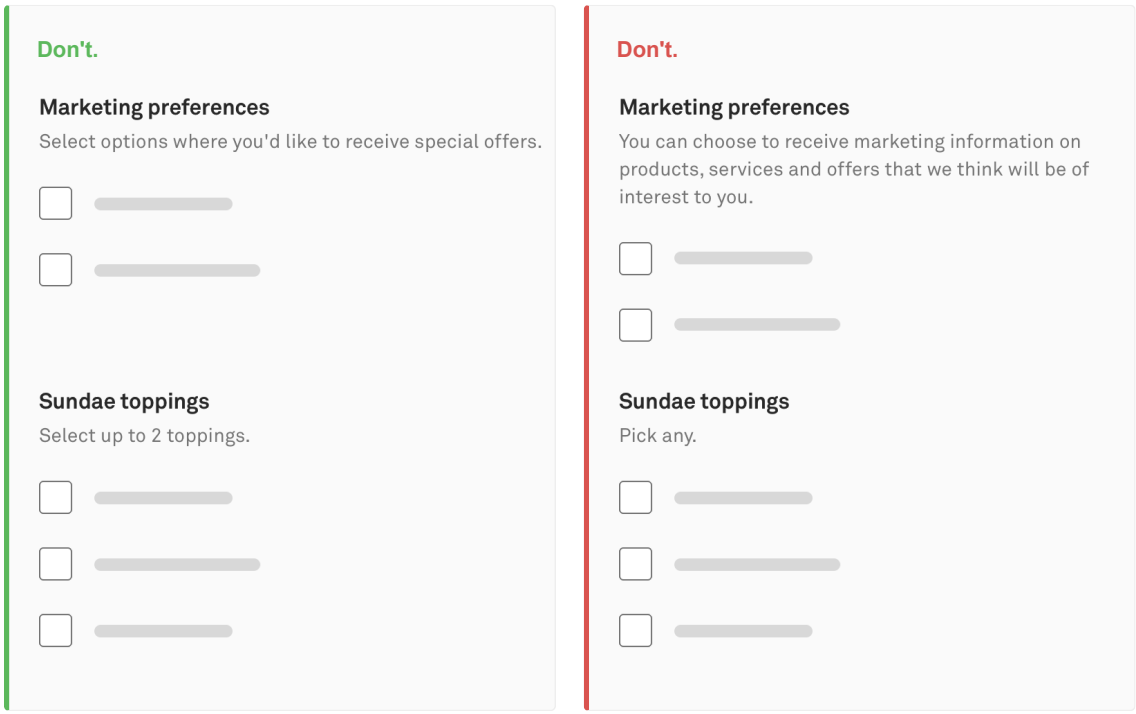
Help text is the optional text displayed below the group label. It provides assistance to the user if they require more context or instruction to aid them with their selection.

Examples of help text include:

1. Specifying a minimum / maximum number of selections required or allowed.
2. Elaborating on the outcome to the user if they make any selections.

Help text should:

- Only be used if it's necessary to provide specific instruction or context to users.
- Ask users to 'select' options instead of 'pick' or 'choose'.
    - 'Select' implies more freedom to select many options whereas 'choose' implies an either/or selection.
- Be kept short and concise, keeping it to 1 line of text where possible.
- Be written as a sentence with proper punctuation.



3. Error Text

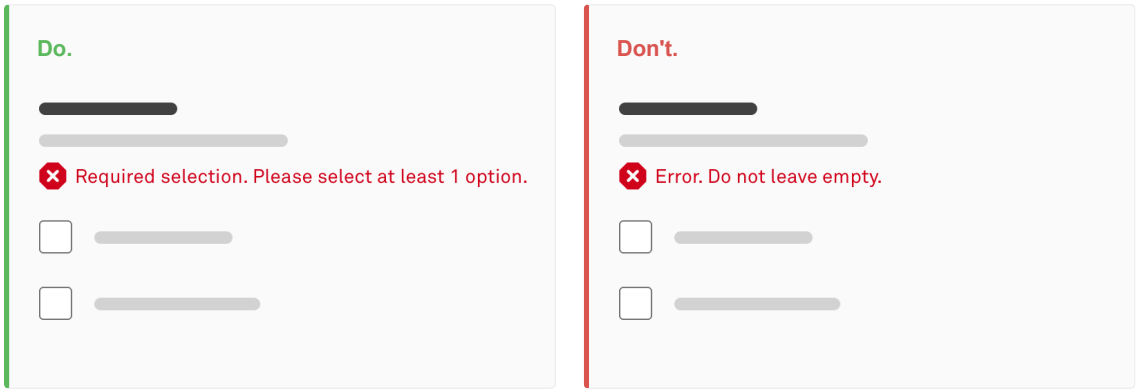
Error text must provide clear instruction to users on what the error is and how to fix it. Don't let users guess what the solution should be.

Checkbox group will surface an error when:

1. User leaves a required checkbox group unselected when submitting a form.
2. User fails to meet a minimum selection requirement for the checkbox group.

Error text should:

- Indicate the issue and instruct how to fix it. The more specific you can be about the problem and solution, the better.
- Be short and concise, avoid lengthy sentences.
- Use passive voice, so user doesn't feel like they're being blamed for the error.
- Be written as a sentence with proper punctuation.
- Not include the word 'Error'.

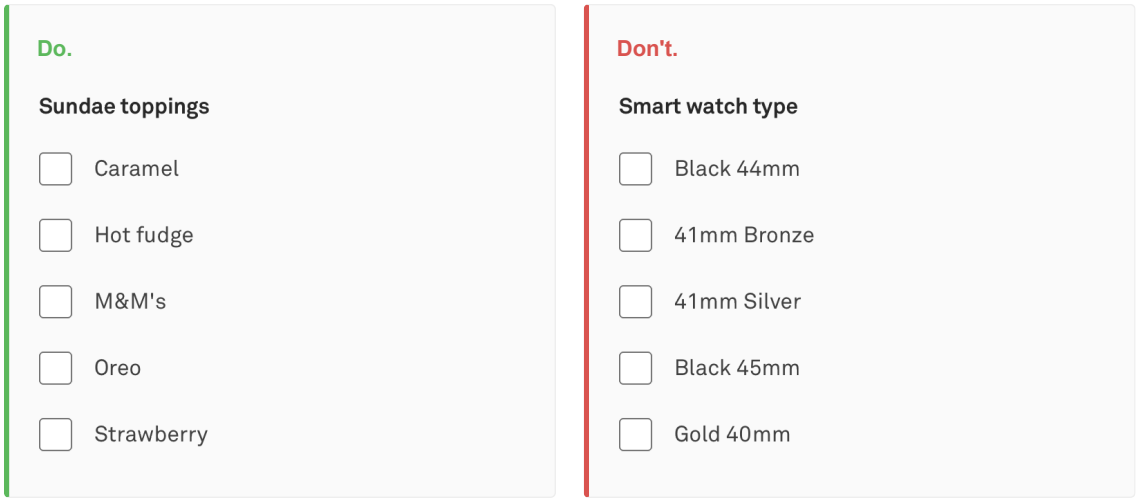


4. Checkbox Label

Each checkbox must have a Checkbox Label, which should make sense as individual items and as part of a whole Checkbox Group.

When writing up a list of checkbox labels:

- Describe all items in the same format for consistency (single word, phrase or sentence).
- Keep each label in singular form.
- Write each individual label in accordance with guidelines for a standalone checkbox label.

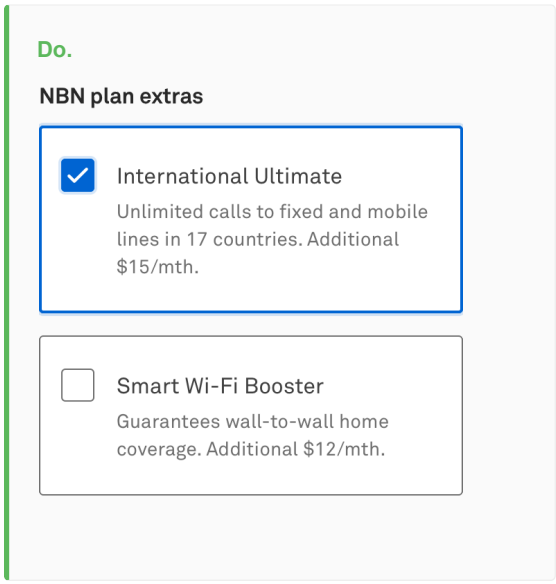


5. Checkbox Description

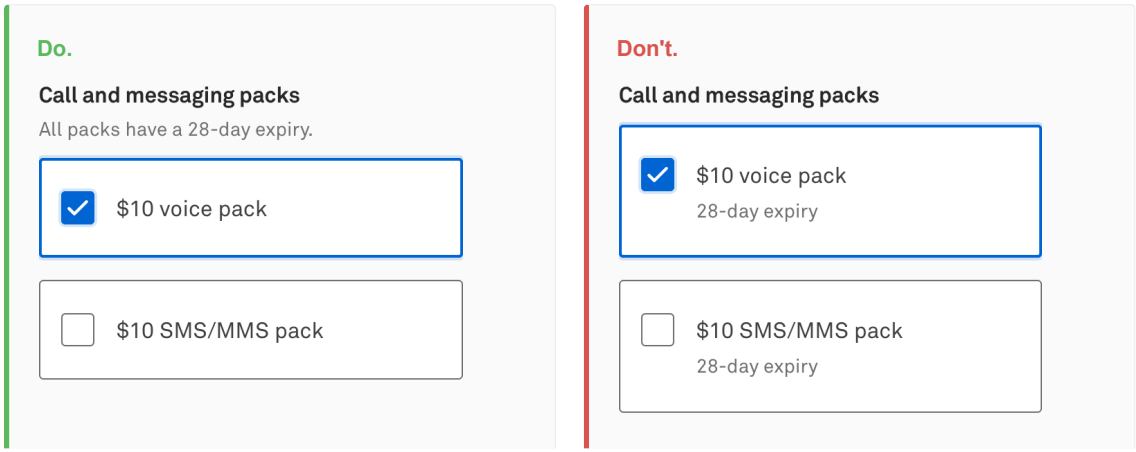
Checkbox Description is optional to support a Checkbox Label if it will aid the user with their selection. Carefully consider whether additional description will add value to the user or whether the Checkbox Label is sufficient.

> ⚠ For accessibility, screen readers will read out the Checkbox Label and Checkbox Description together. Both should be kept succinct to avoid cognitive overload for the user.

- Only provide additional description if it will help users make a decision by distinguishing between the options.



- Don't duplicate the same description for all checkboxes. Consider adding it to the Help Text if it's applicable to the entire checkbox group.



- Avoid adding excessive description within each Checkbox (e.g. fine print or product T&Cs).

Don't.

☐ Add Telstra TV

Get Netflix, Stan, Foxtel Now, live sport & catchup TV all in one place. Pause and rewind free-to-air TV. Search across apps and channels with a single voice remote. A minimum internet speed of 3.5Mbps is recommended. Antenna required to access free-to-air channels in your area. Subscription and data charges apply.

- Always use sentence case.
- Include proper punctuation when writing in full sentences.

Please refer to additional content guidelines listed in Telstra's Content Style Guide.

Accessibility Considerations

Checkbox Group are designed to meet the same WCAG 2.1 Success Criteria as outlined for standalone checkboxes.

In addition semantic grouping of related form controls is required. This has been met using the following technique:

Providing a description for groups of form controls using fieldset and legend elements

This technique relates to:

- Success Criterion 1.3.1: Info and Relationships
- Success Criterion 3.3.2: Labels or Instructions

Keyboard

Interaction	Keystrokes
Move keyboard focus to checkbox	TAB
Toggle checkbox on or off	SPACEBAR

- Users must be able to navigate to and interact with a checkbox using keyboard alone.
- A clear visible indicator should also be present when the checkbox has focus.

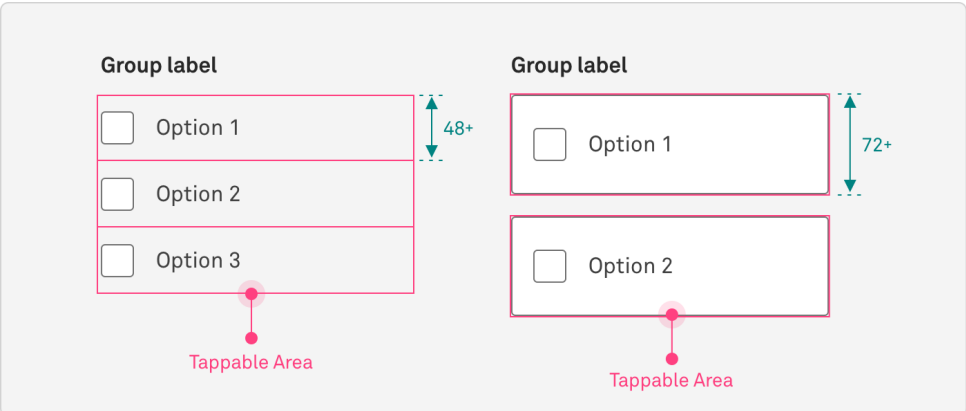
Screen Reader

Screen reader behaviour and the ordering of announcements will vary depending on the platform/browser/screen reader combinations being used.

On screen reader focus of a checkbox within checkbox group, announcements may include:

- The **group label** (<legend>) Depending on the configuration, some screen readers read out the legend either *with every form element*, *once*, or, rarely, *not at all*.
- The **label** of the checkbox
- The **role** ie "checkbox" or "tickbox"
- The **state** of the checkbox, ie "Ticked", "Not Ticked", "Checked" or "Not Checked"

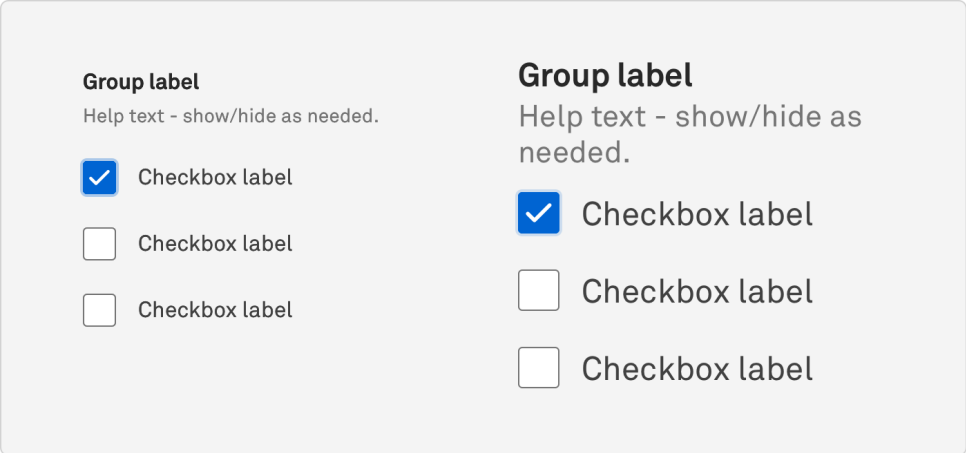
Interactions



You can use keyboard keys to navigate between the options, see Keyboard in Accessibility

For individual checkbox interactions and tappable area detail, see Interactions section in Checkbox.

Capabilities



Robust Layout.

Components are scaled automatically based on the font size and zoom level in user's browser settings.

Related Patterns

- Checkbox
- Multi Select Row
- Radio Group
- Single Select Row

No labels

Atlassian